VoyagerMapper quick start

v0.1.1

Install VoyagerMapper on Windows, then make a map file for the Trail Tech Voyager Pro in four steps. The default settings make a file that loads on the device. You do not have to change them.

0. Install and start the app

You do this once. You need an internet connection. If you prefer an installer, download `voymap-setup-<version>.exe` from the Releases page at `https://github.com/GnomeTek/VoyagerMapper/releases` and skip to step 0.4.

0.1 Install Python

1. Open `https://www.python.org/downloads/` and download Python for Windows (3.10 or newer).
2. Start the installer.
3. On the first screen, check **Add python.exe to PATH**.
4. Click **Install Now** and wait for the installer to finish.

If Python is already installed, skip this step.

0.2 Download the source

1. Open `https://github.com/GnomeTek/VoyagerMapper`.
2. Click the green **Code** button.
3. Click **Download ZIP**.
4. Open the downloaded file `VoyagerMapper-main.zip` and extract it to a folder you keep, for example `C:\Users\<you>\Documents\VoyagerMapper`.

The folder must contain `setup.bat`, `run_gui.bat`, and `pyproject.toml`. If you use git, you can instead run `git clone https://github.com/GnomeTek/VoyagerMapper.git`.

0.3 Run setup

1. Open the folder from step 0.2.
2. Double-click **setup.bat**.

A command window opens. The script makes a Python environment in a `.venv` subfolder, installs the app and its libraries (about 200 MB, most of it the Qt map view), and runs the self-test. This takes a few minutes. The last lines you see are:

```
26 passed in ...s

Setup complete. Double-click run_gui.bat to start voymap.
Press any key to continue . . .
```

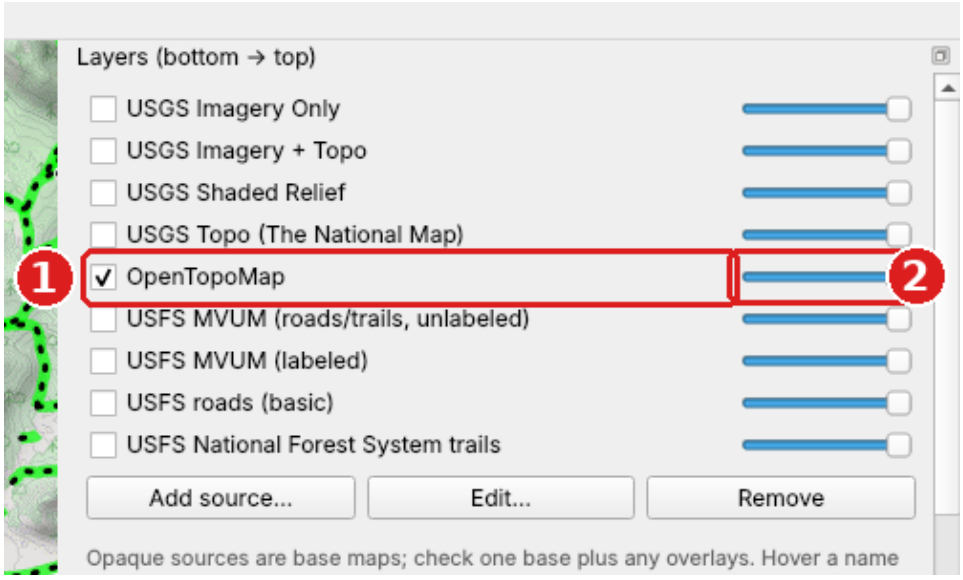
Press a key to close the window. If the window shows `Setup failed`, read the lines above it. The usual cause is that Python is not on the PATH: repeat step 0.1 and make sure the **Add python.exe to PATH** box is checked.

0.4 Start the app

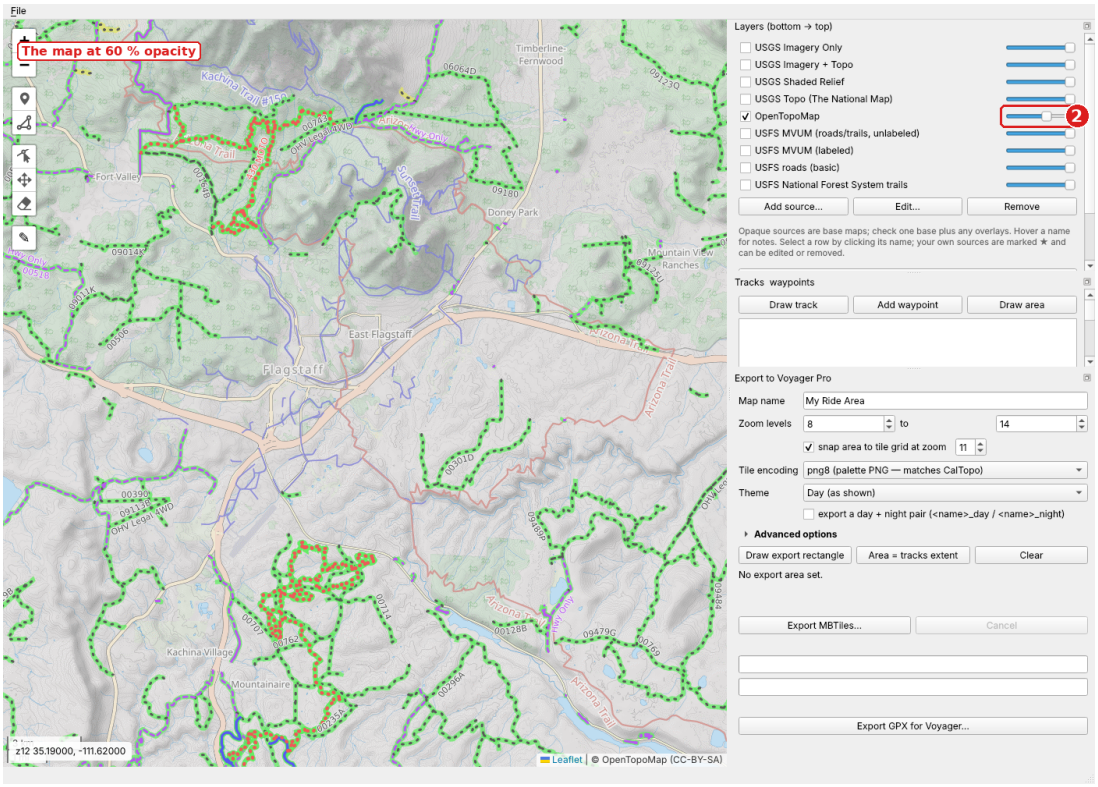
1. Double-click **run_gui.bat** in the same folder.
2. Wait for the window with the map to open.

If you used the installer, start **voymap** from the Start menu instead. The map starts on northern Arizona. Pan and zoom to your riding area. A command window stays open behind the app while it runs. Close the app to close it.

1. Select the map and set the opacity

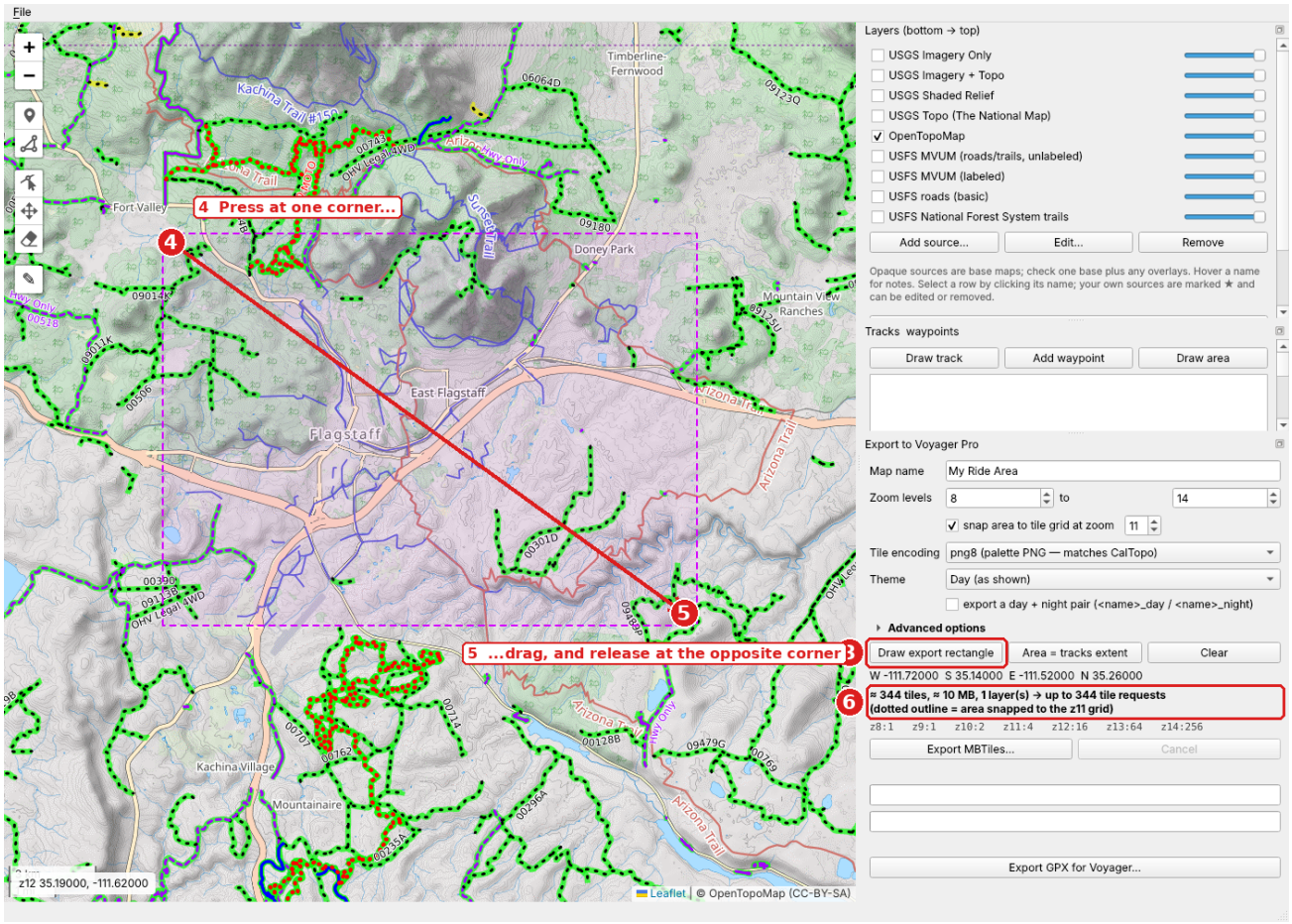


1. In the **Layers** panel, check the box next to the map you want **(1)**. Check one base map, for example *OpenTopoMap* or *USGS Topo*. You can also check overlays, for example *USFS MVUM (labeled)*.
2. Drag the slider at the right of the row to set the opacity **(2)**. The map view shows the result at once.



The slider also sets the opacity in the exported file. For a base map, keep the slider at 100 %. Use a lower value for an overlay that hides the base map.

2. Draw the export area

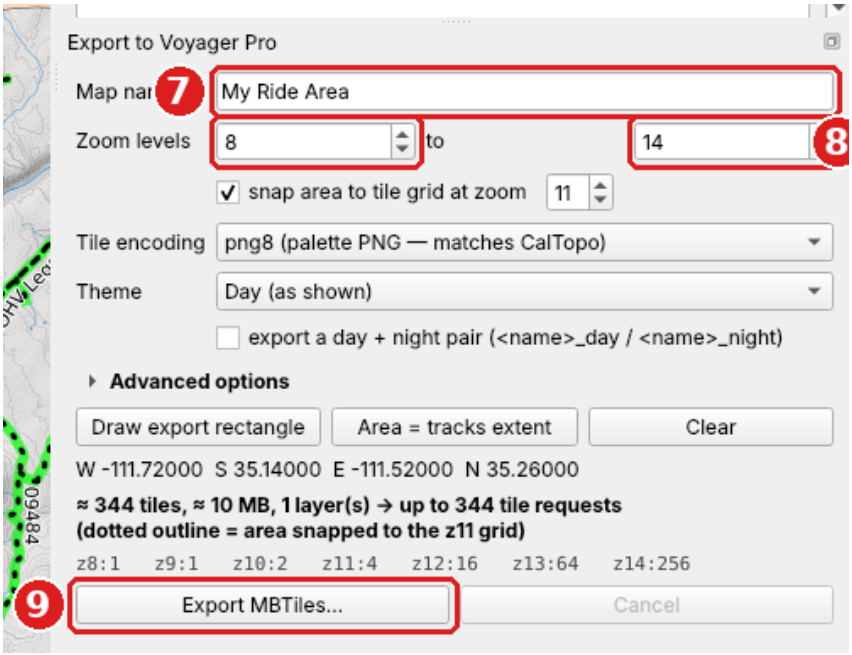


1. In the **Export to Voyager Pro** panel, click **Draw export rectangle (3)**.
2. On the map, press the mouse button at one corner of the area **(4)**.
3. Hold the button, drag to the opposite corner, and release **(5)**.

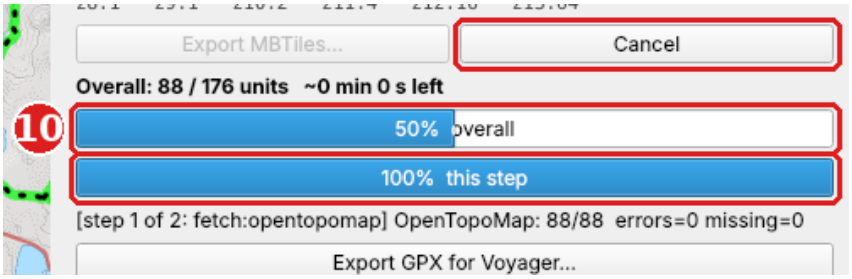
The app shows the area as a dashed magenta rectangle. The line under the buttons shows the tile count and the approximate file size **(6)**. A thin dotted outline shows the area snapped to the tile grid. That is the area the app exports.

To change the area, click **Draw export rectangle** again and draw a new rectangle. **Clear** removes the area.

3. Export the map



1. Type a name in **Map name** (7). The Voyager Pro shows this name in its list of custom maps.
2. Keep the **Zoom levels** at the default, 8 to 14 (8). More zoom levels make a larger file. Each level above 14 makes the file four times larger.
3. Click **Export MBTiles...** (9).
4. In the file dialog, choose where to save the `.mbtiles` file and click **Save**.



The top bar shows the overall progress (10). The bottom bar shows the current step. The export downloads the tiles for each layer, then writes the file. A message box opens when the export is complete. **Cancel** stops the export.

4. Load the map on the Voyager Pro

1. Copy the `.mbtiles` file to the microSD card of the Voyager Pro.
2. Put the card in the Voyager Pro.
3. On the device, go to the map screen.
4. Tap **CUSTOM MAPS**.
5. Tap **IMPORT A NEW FILE** and select the file.

The device processes the file and shows a message when it is done.

Tips

- The app keeps the downloaded tiles in a cache. A second export of the same area, for example a night version, does not download the tiles again.
- Select **Night** in **Theme** to make a dark map. Check **export a day + night pair** to make both files in one export.
- **File** → **Save project** saves the area, the layers, and the export settings, so you can make the same map again later.